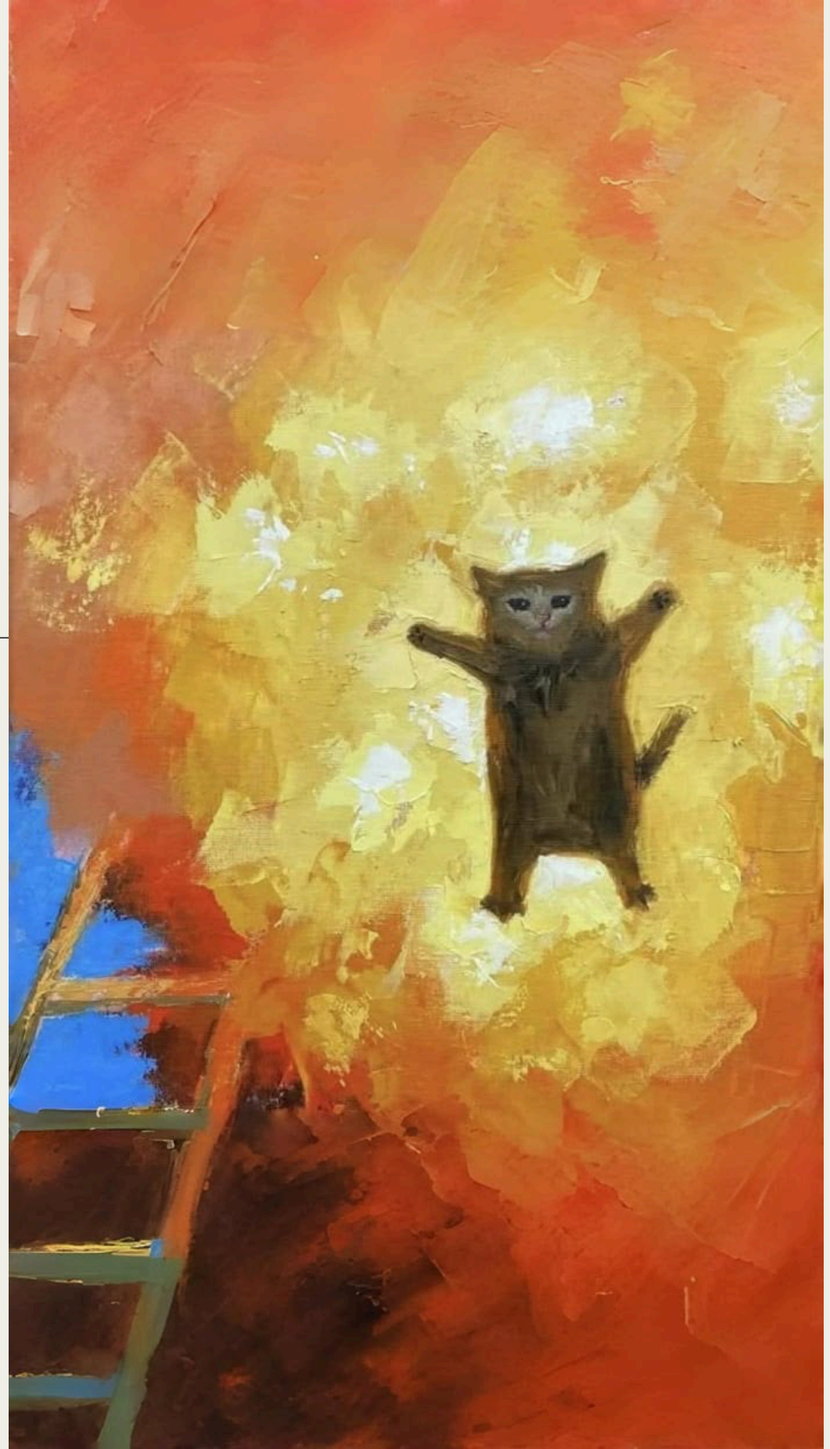
Understaning

THE BRAND

BY SAAD AHMED



UNDERSTANDING THE BRIEF

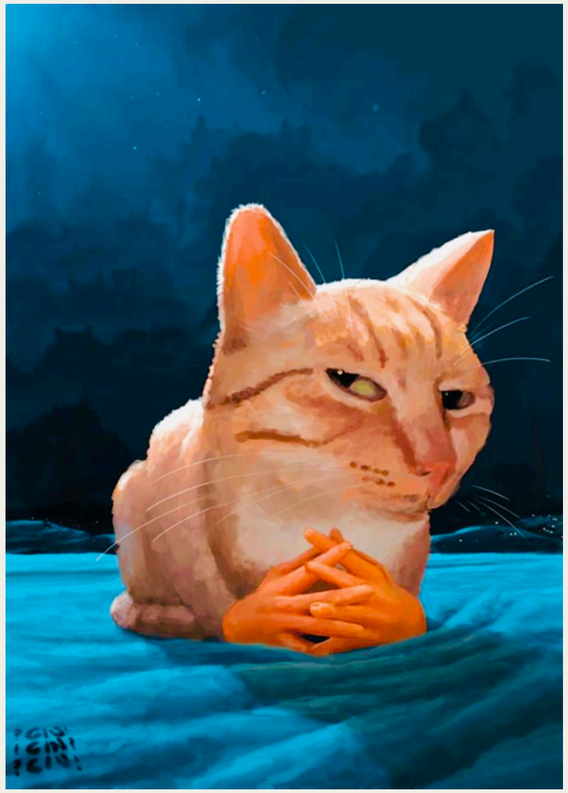
The Order of Operations

THE C.O.R.E.S. METHOD — designed to decode, structure, and challenge a client brief before you begin any creative work.

1. CONTEXT (THE "WHY")

Before deciding how something should look, you must understand why it needs to exist. Clients often ask for a deliverable (e.g., "we need a new website") when they actually have a business problem (e.g., "our bounce rate is 80% because the current site is hard to navigate").

- **The Business Trigger:** What recent event prompted this project? (A new competitor, a product launch, declining sales?)
- **The Ultimate Objective:** If this project is wildly successful, what business metric changes?
- **The Current State:** What are they currently doing, and why is it failing?



UNDERSTANDING THE BRIEF

2. OBJECTS & CONSTRAINTS (THE "WHAT")

This defines the sandbox you are playing in. Missing a technical constraint early on can derail an entire project later.

- **Scope & Deliverables:** Exactly what formats, sizes, and platforms are expected?
- **Hard Constraints:** What are the absolute limits? (e.g., budget caps, launch dates, legacy software you must integrate with).
- **Mandatories:** What must be included? (Specific logos, legal disclaimers, brand colors).

UNDERSTANDING THE BRIEF

3. RECIPIENTS (THE "WHO")

A design is only effective if it resonates with the end-user. The brief should define the audience beyond basic demographics.

- **The Core Persona:** Who is the primary user? (Move beyond "Women 18-35" to "Time-poor millennial moms who prioritize organic ingredients").
- **Pain Points:** What problem does the audience have that this design/product solves?
- **The Desired Action:** What exactly do we want them to do after seeing or interacting with the design?

UNDERSTANDING THE BRIEF

4. EXECUTION & VIBE (THE "FEEL")

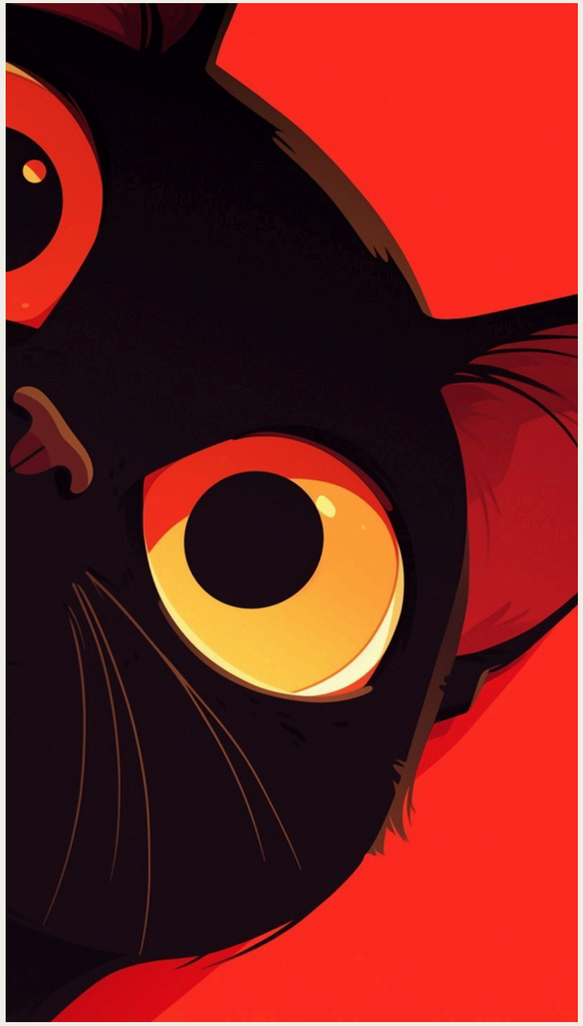
This is where you extract the aesthetic and emotional direction. "Make it pop" is not an artistic direction; you need to translate their feelings into visual language.

- **Brand Personality:** If the brand were a person, how would they speak and dress?
- **Emotional Takeaway:** How should the user feel immediately after engaging with this? (Reassured, excited, urgent, calm?)
- **Competitive Landscape:** Who are the competitors, and do we want to blend in with industry standards or disrupt them?

UNDERSTANDING THE BRIEF

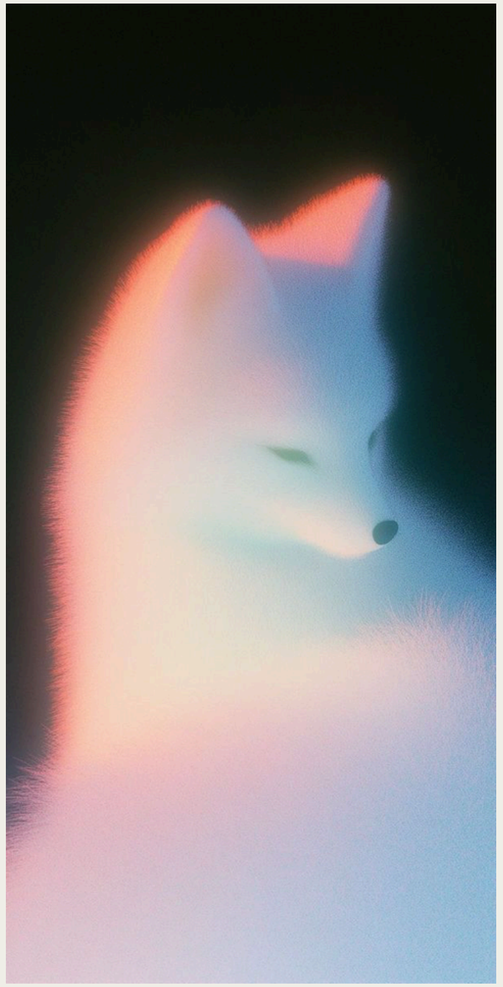
The Brief Often Says...	You Need to Ask...	To Uncover...
"We need a modern logo."	"What is about your current logo that feels outdated to your customers?"	The underlying business problem.
"Our target is everyone."	"Who is your most profitable customer right now?"	The primary user persona.
"Make it look premium."	"Can you show me a brand outside your industry you consider premium?"	The visual benchmark and tone.
"We need this in two weeks."	"If we launch a V1 in two weeks, what features can we push to V2?"	Flexibility in scope and constraints.

BRAND GUIDELINE



BRAND GUIDELINE

A brand guideline (often called a brand style guide) is essentially a rulebook. It dictates exactly how your brand presents itself to the world across every possible touchpoint — from the logo on a physical clothing tag to the tone of voice used in an Instagram reel, or the typography on an invoice from your marketing agency. Without it, a brand quickly becomes a disjointed collection of fonts, colors, and messaging that confuses customers and dilutes trust



BRAND GUIDELINE

BEHANCE LINK

Write down an image prompt

TIME: 15 MIN

Write down an image prompt

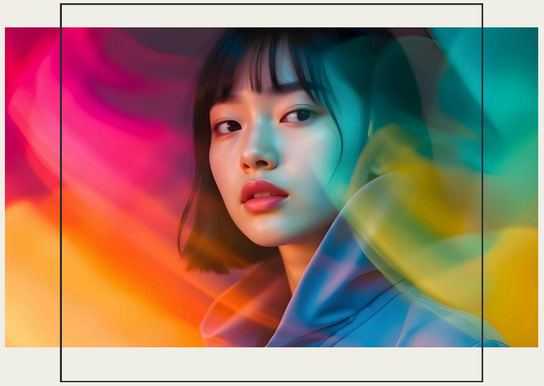
TIME: 15 MIN

Technical Art Direction in AI

MOVING FROM "VIBES" TO PHYSICS-BASED PROMPT ENGINEERING

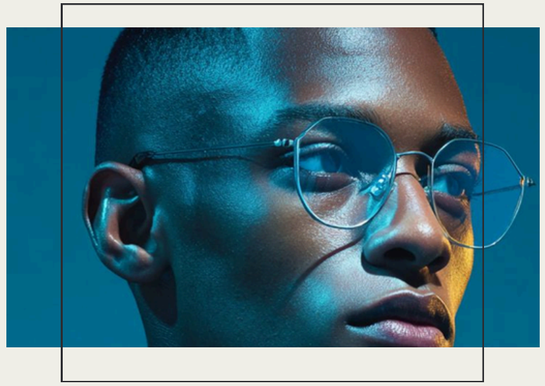
BY SAAD AHMED

WHY YOUR PROMPTS ARE FAILING?



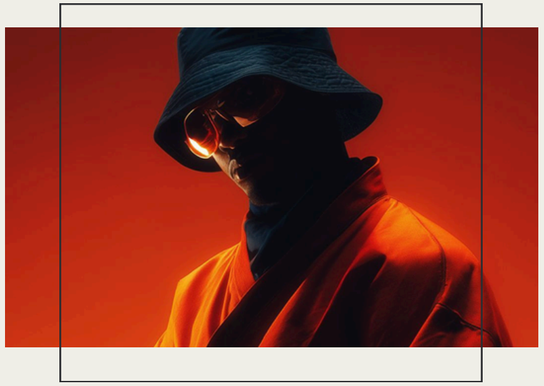
The Old Way

Using "vibe" words like cinematic, stunning, hyperrealistic, 8k.



The New Way

Using Physics & Engineering language.



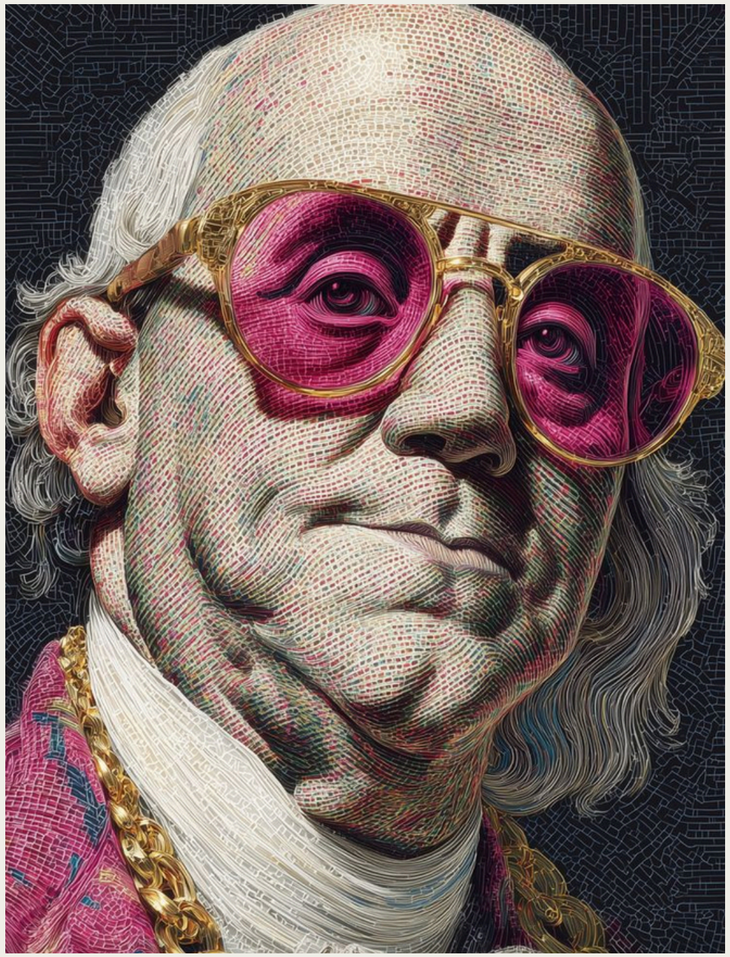
The Hard Truth

AI models are trained on captioned photography datasets. They don't understand "beauty"; they understand "refractive index" and "85mm lens compression."

THE PROMPT HIERARCHY (THE 7-LAYER STACK)

The Order of Operations

THE RULE: ORDER DETERMINES PRIORITY. IF THE PHYSICS ARE AT THE END, THE MODEL IGNORES THEM.



THE PROMPT HIERARCHY (THE 7-LAYER STACK)

1 *Hero Subject:*
Geometry and Action.

2 *Material Physics:*
Surface behavior and textures.

3 *Composition:*
Camera lens and angle.

4 *Lighting Logic:*
The "Virtual Studio" setup.

5 *Atmosphere:*
Environmental particles and motion.

6 *Mood/Style:*
Editorial intent.

7 *Constraints:*
What to exclude.

HERO SUBJECT & ACTION (THE GEOMETRY)

Specific model names, exact materials, ergonomic actions.

- **Examples:**
  - **"A 1960s Leica M3 camera."**
  - **"A matte-titanium fountain pen."**
  - **"A human hand performing a Tripod Grip."**

MATERIAL PHYSICS (THE SHADER)

Surface tension, micro-texture, light interaction, viscosity.

Examples

Liquids:

0.5mm micro-condensation, vertical gravity streaks, high-tension meniscus.

Metals:

Anisotropic brushed-steel grain, specular edge highlights.

Skin:

Visible pores (0.1mm), sub-surface scattering (SSS), natural skin oil sheen.

COMPOSITION & CAMERA GEOMETRY (THE OPTICS)

Focal length, f-stop (aperture), camera angle, distance. **Examples**

Lens:

85mm f/1.2 prime lens (Portrait standard).

Angle:

Worm’s-eye view (low angle) looking up.

Focus:

Tack-sharp focus on the foreground logo, shallow depth of field (f/1.8).

VISUAL EXAMPLES (ANLGES)

LIGHTING LOGIC (THE PHOTOMETRY)

Light direction, color temperature (Kelvin), intensity, light modifiers. **Examples**

Key Light:

Warm key light (3200K) from 45° camera-left.

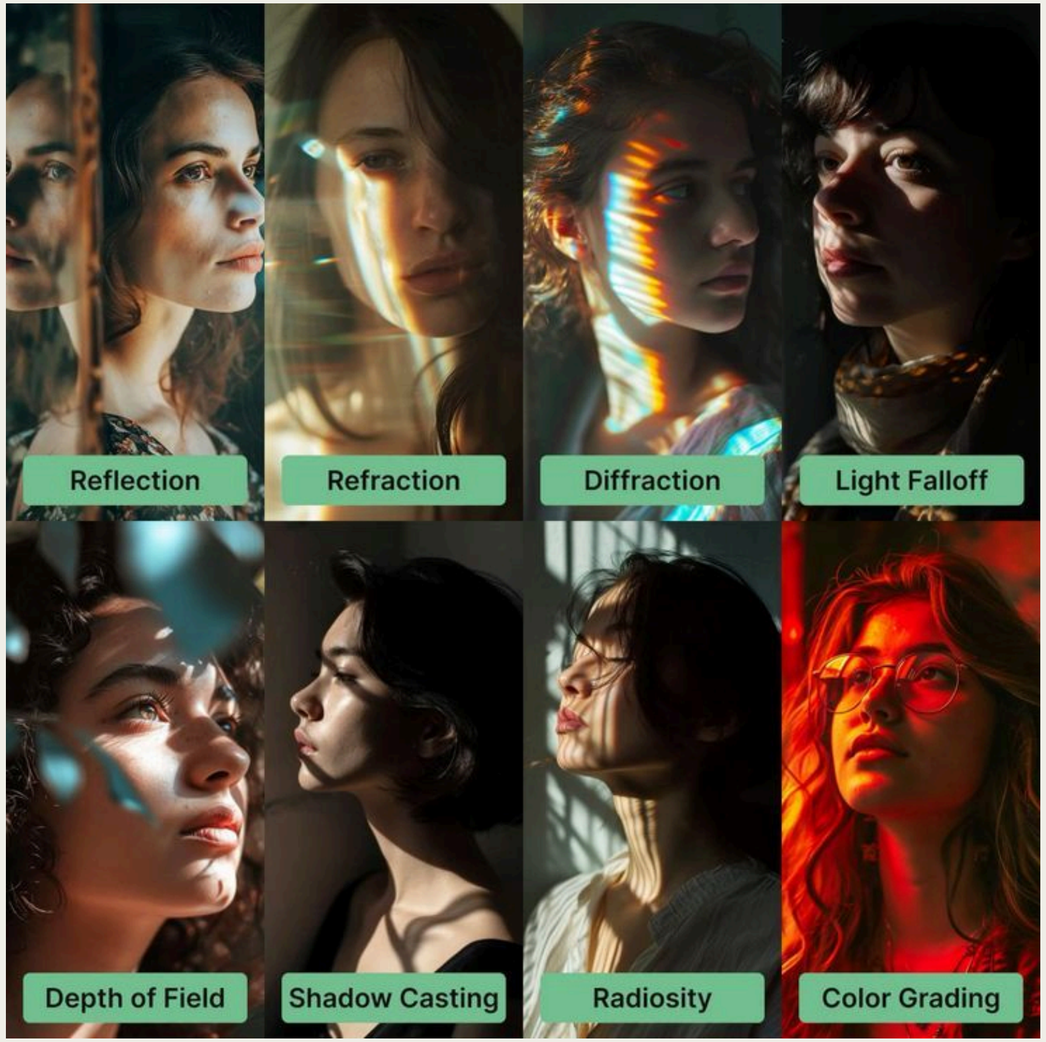
Rim Light:

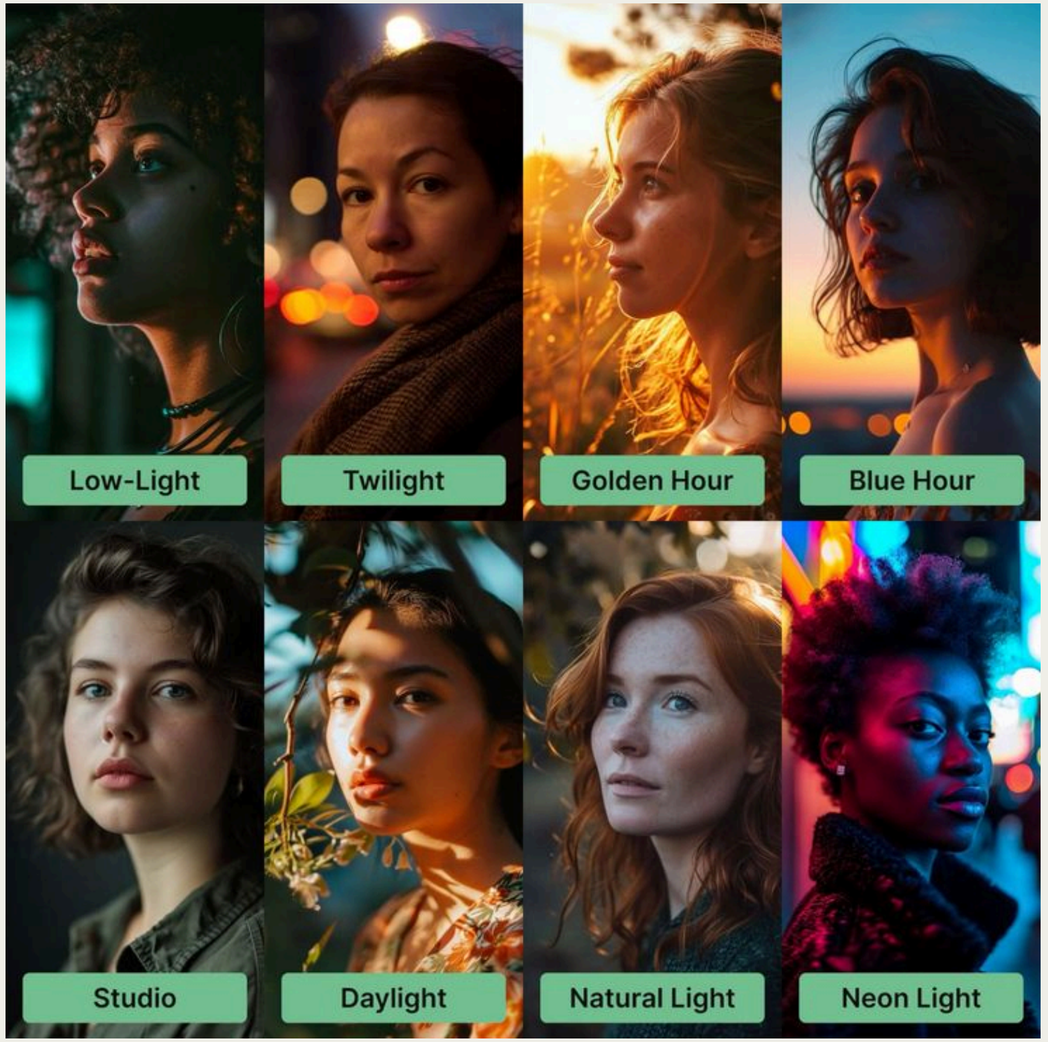
Cool blue kicker (6000K) from 170° behind to define edges.

Fill Light:

Soft white bounce at 20% intensity to lift shadows.

VISUAL EXAMPLES (LIGHTS)



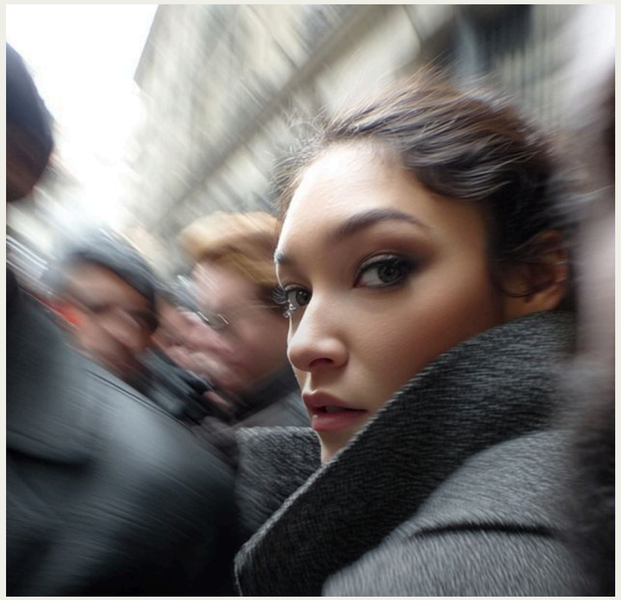


ATMOSPHERE & MOTION (THE ENVIRONMENT)

Particulates, shutter speed, weather effects. **Examples**

Particles:

Floating dust motes visible in the light beams.



Motion:

Frozen-motion splash (1/8000s shutter speed).

Environment:

Subtle cinematic haze, volcanic ash, or morning mist.

MOOD & EDITORIAL INTENT (THE STYLE)

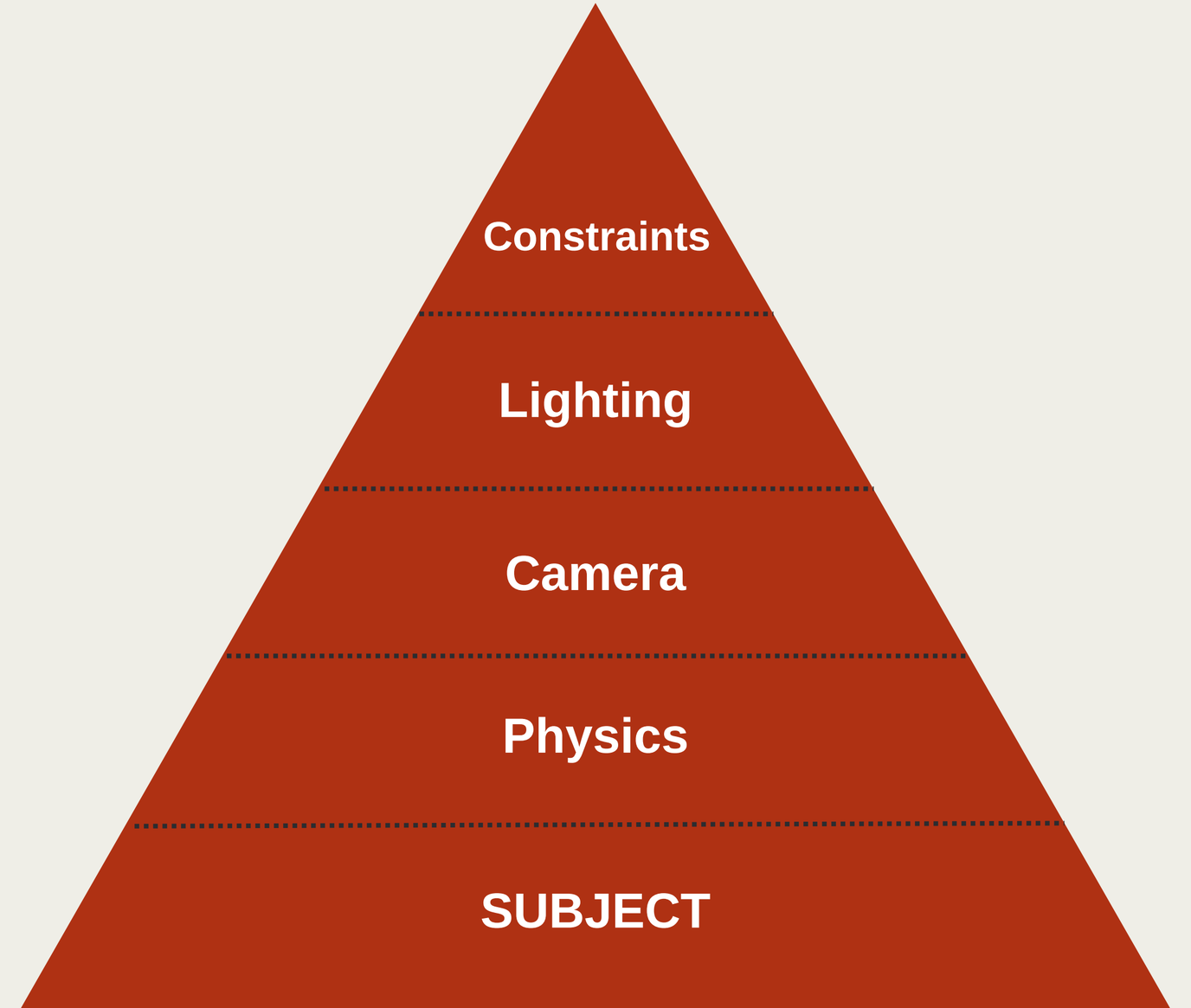
Color grading, magazine style, brand aesthetic. **Examples**

- "Desaturated earth tones, Kodak Portra 400 film stock look."
- "High-fashion Vogue editorial style, stark shadows."
- "Cyberpunk neon-noir, high-contrast teal and orange."

CONSTRAINTS (THE SAFETY LAYER)

Negative prompts, technical prohibitions. **Examples**

- "No CGI gloss, no waxy skin, no plastic textures."
- "No warped text, no lens distortion on product edges."
- "No extra fingers, no impossible anatomy."


Constraints
Lighting
Camera
Physics
SUBJECT

IF THE IMAGE IS STRUGGLING

LOOK

LIGHTING LOGIC (THE PHOTOMETRY)

Light direction, color temperature (Kelvin), intensity, light modifiers. **Examples**

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Warm key light (3200K) from 45° camera-left.

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REALISM

MATERIAL PHYSICS (THE SHADER)

Surface tension, micro-texture, light interaction, viscosity. **Examples**

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0.5mm micro-condensation, vertical gravity streaks, high-tension meniscus.

Metals:

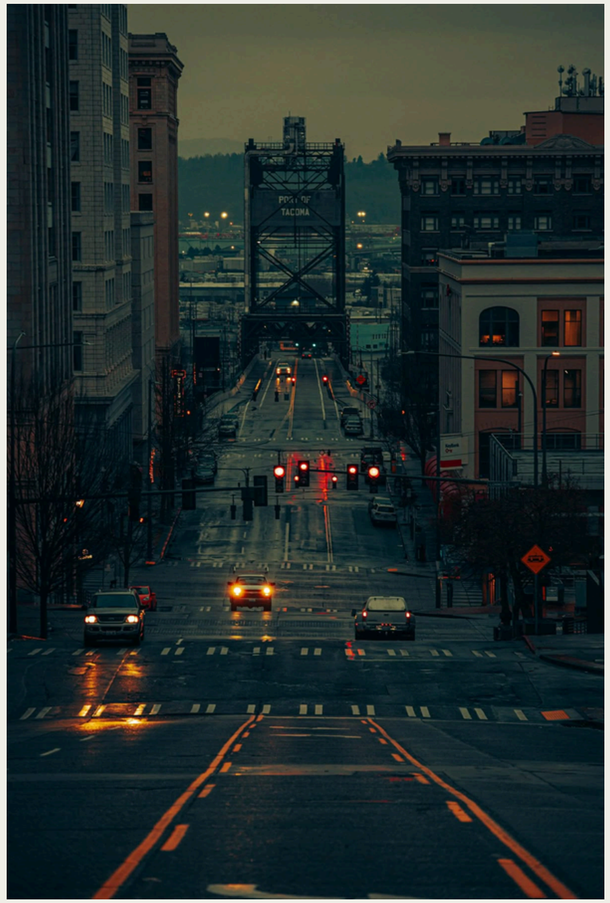
Anisotropic brushed-steel grain, specular edge highlights.

Skin:

Visible pores (0.1mm), sub-surface scattering (SSS), natural skin oil sheen.

Mood & Editorial Intent (The Style)

If you prompt "Moody" at the beginning, the AI might make the lighting dark, the physics messy, and the subject vague. By placing it at the end, you are saying: "Build a technically perfect product shot, and then color-grade it to look 'Moody'."



Narrative Editorial Styles

Minimalist

Focus on breathability, clean lines, and high-end serenity.

Key words

Negative space, monastic simplicity, airy composition, muted palette, high-key minimalism.

High-Fashion

Dramatic, avant-garde, and intentionally "unnatural."

Key words

High-contrast, avant-garde, stark editorial, theatrical, sharp-edged shadows, glossy finish.

Grit & Realism

To feel unposed, raw, and authentic.

Key words

Raw documentary style, candid, unpolished, grainy, high-iso, found-lighting, journalistic integrity.

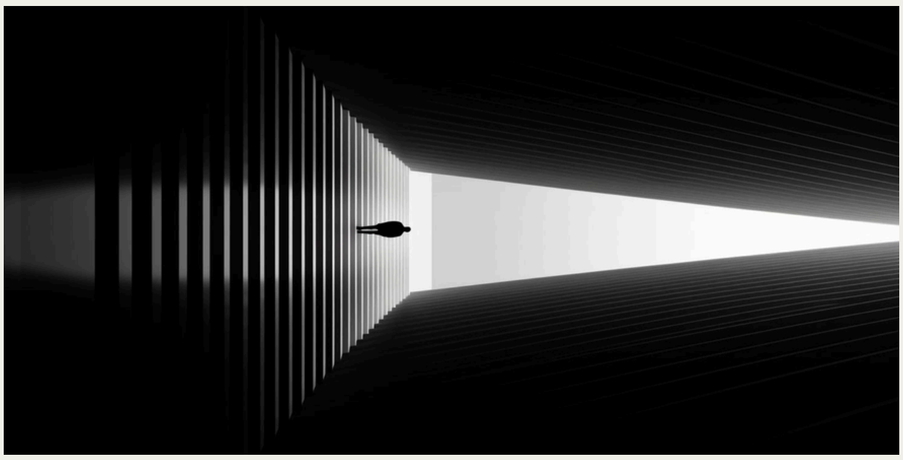
Luxury & Opulence

To look expensive, solid, and timeless.

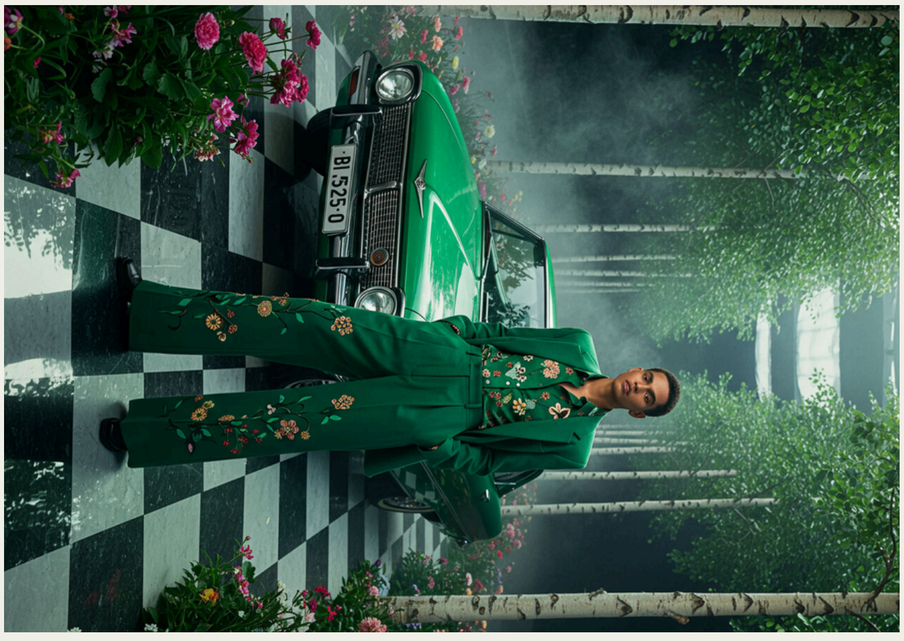
Key words

Statuesque, monolithic, rich textures, deep blacks, golden-hour warmth, classicism.

Minimalist



High-Fashion



Grit & Realism

Luxury & Opulence

Color Science & Grading

Instead of saying "nice colors," use specific color-grading terminology.

Analog/Film Emulation	**Key words** Kodak Portra 400 (Warm, natural skin), Fujifilm Velvia (Saturated greens/blues), Kodachrome (Vintage 60s), Technicolor (Hyper-saturated mid-century).
Digital Grading	**Key words** Teal and Orange (Modern cinema), Monochromatic (Single color family), Desaturated (Moody/Post-apocalyptic), High-chroma (Neon/Pop-art), Low-fidelity (Lo-fi) (Aesthetically imperfect).

Analog/Film Emulation

Digital Grading

Dynamic Range & Contrast

Defines the "weight" of the image.

Low-Key

Dark and dramatic.

Key words

Chiaroscuro, heavy shadows, "crushed" blacks, moody, mysterious.

High-Key

Bright and optimistic.

Key words

Blown-out highlights, airy, optimistic, clinical, shadowless.

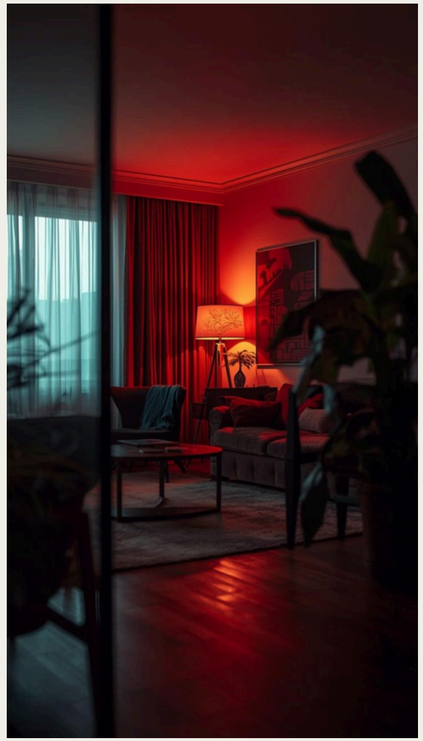
Faded/Vintage

Key words

Raised blacks, low-contrast, washed-out, sepia-tinted, vintage-matte finish.

Dynamic Range & Contrast

Low-Key



High-Key

Faded/Vintage

Keyword Bank for Mood & Intent

Mood Type	Key Technical Phrases
Luxury	Timeless elegance, premium finish, statuesque lighting, deep shadow density.
Tech/Future	Cyberpunk aesthetic, neon-noir, sleek, sterile, clinical-blue tint.
Nostalgia	Kodak Portra 400 grain, 1970s aesthetics, sun-drenched, nostalgic haze.
Aggressive/Sport	High-action, dynamic tension, grit, sweat-texture, high-contrast, sharp.
Whimsical/Soft	Ethereal, pastel-palette, soft-focus edges, dreamlike, gentle glow.

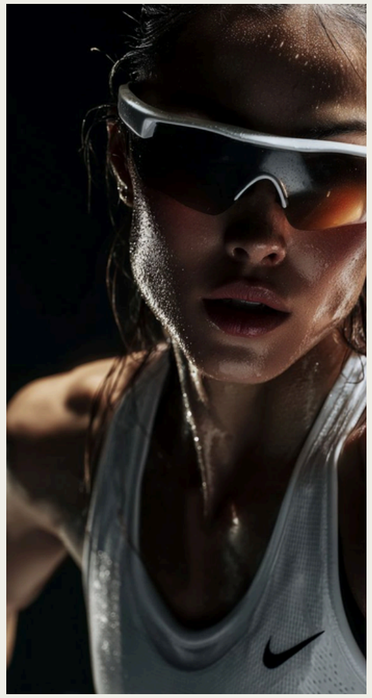
Keyword Bank for Mood & Intent

Luxury

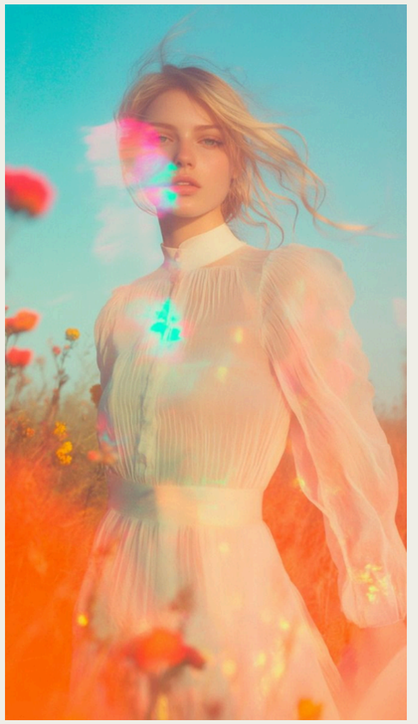
Tech/Future

Nostalgia

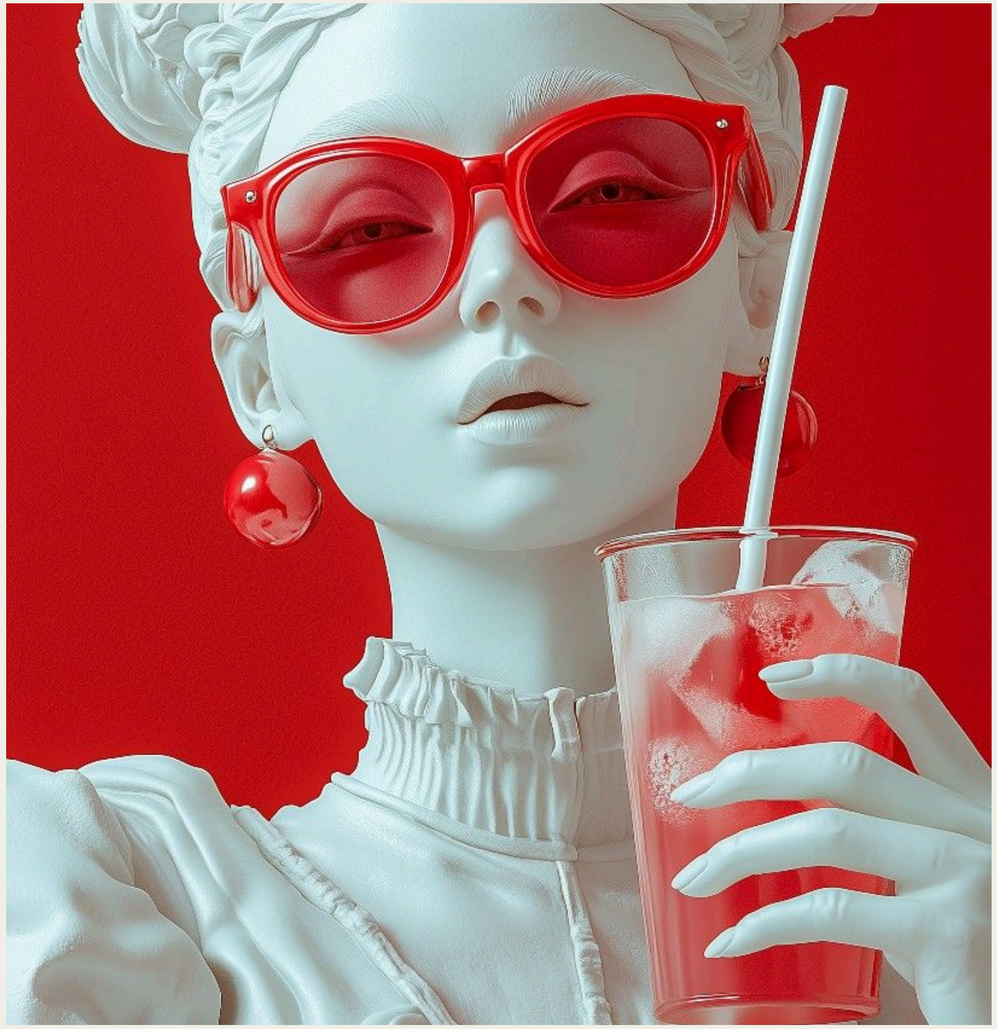
Aggressive/ Sport



Whimsical/Soft



Material Physics
(Surface Engineering)



PROMPTING THE "SHADER"

Surface Tension:

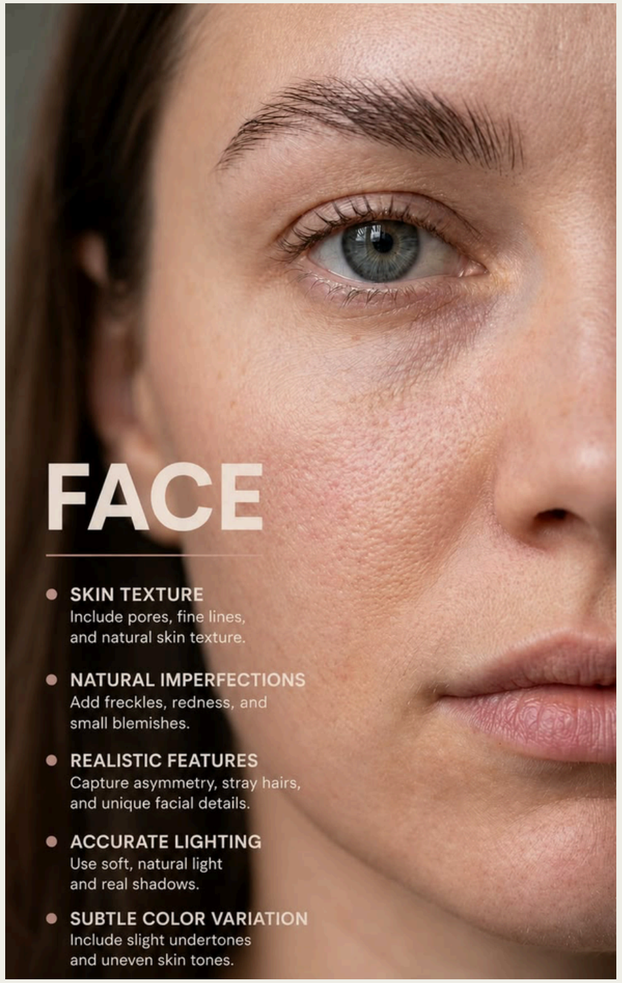
Use "0.5mm micro-condensation" or "high-tension meniscus" for liquids.

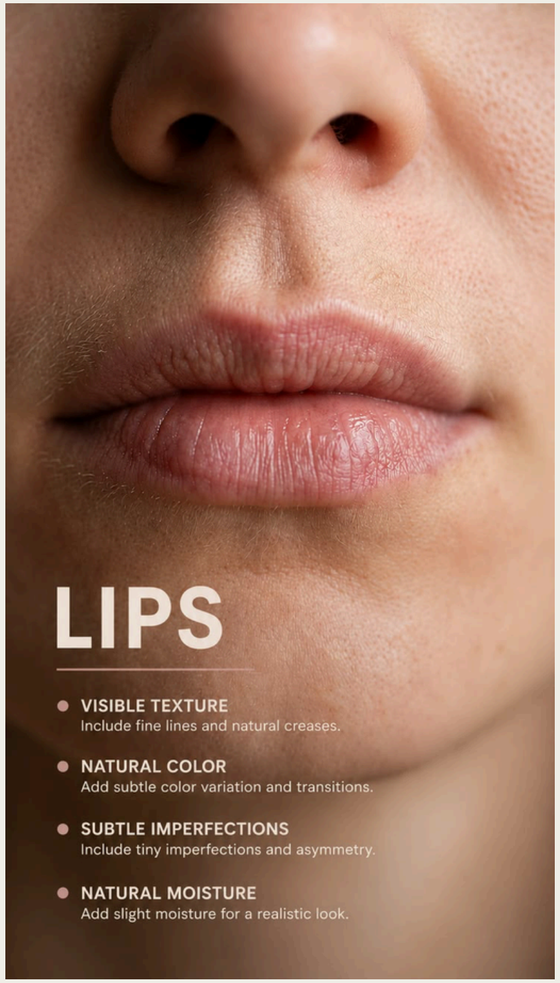
Anisotropy:

linear brushed-metal grain" to define how light stretches across surfaces.

Subsurface Scattering:

Crucial for skin and liquids. Defines how light "glows" through a surface.


FACE
SKIN TEXTURE
Include pores, fine lines, and natural skin texture.
NATURAL IMPERFECTIONS
Add freckles, redness, and small blemishes.
REALISTIC FEATURES
Capture asymmetry, stray hairs, and unique facial details.
ACCURATE LIGHTING
Use soft, natural light and real shadows.
SUBTLE COLOR VARIATION
Include slight undertones and uneven skin tones.


LIPS
VISIBLE TEXTURE
Include fine lines and natural creases.
NATURAL COLOR
Add subtle color variation and transitions.
SUBTLE IMPERFECTIONS
Include tiny imperfections and asymmetry.
NATURAL MOISTURE
Add slight moisture for a realistic look.

DETAILS
HIGH-RESOLUTION TEXTURES
Use high-resolution skin, hair, and pore textures.
MICRO IMPERFECTIONS
Include pores, fine lines, blemishes, and asymmetry.
NATURAL LIGHTING
Use soft, directional, and realistic lighting.
ACCURATE COLOR & TONES
Match real skin tones and color variations.
REALISTIC DETAILS
Add natural shine, stray hairs, and skin variations.

COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

Prompt

An artistic editorial product shot of a chanel No.5 perfumenbottle floarting in dark reflective water, surrounded by pink and white lotus flowers. **The glass bottle, filled with amber liquid, glows with warm highlights while water droplets cling to its surface. Gentle ripples spread outward, catching the light and creating fluid reflections. Sunlight adds golden flares and subtle rainbow** refractions across the scene, enhancing the sense of purity and luxury. The flowers frame the bottle naturally, their soft petals contrasting with the sharp clarity of the crystal glass. Mood: serene, sensual, and iconic.

HUMAN INTERACTION (THE GRIP ARCHITECTURE)

Don't say "Holding": AI doesn't understand holding.

Do say "Grip Types"

- **Power Grip:** Fingers wrapped, palm contact.
- **Precision Pinch:** Thumb and index meet at the tips.

Pressure Physics:

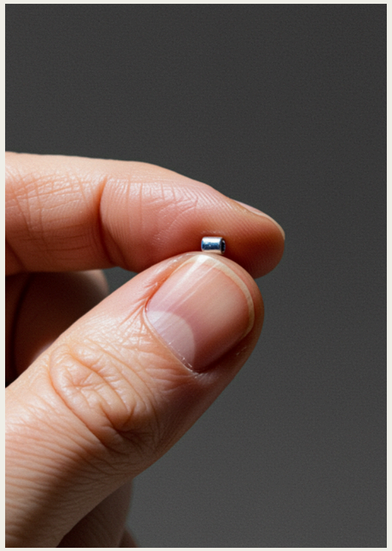
Prompt for "skin indentation" and "blood-displacement paleness" at the contact point.

HUMAN INTERACTION (THE GRIP ARCHITECTURE)

The Precision Pinch (The "Fine Tech" Grip)

- **Best for: Jewelry, micro-chips, needles, small dials, or delicate components.**

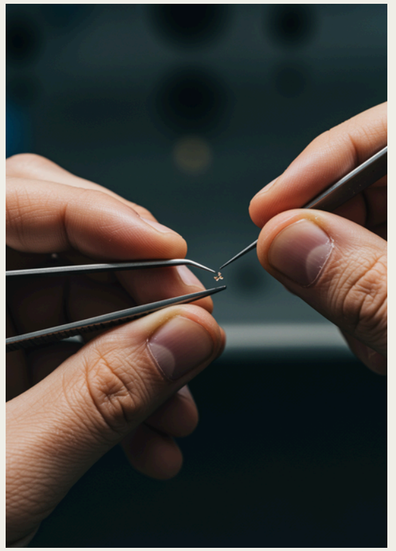
The Physics: The tips of the thumb and index finger meet at a 90-degree angle



- Precision pinch

- Pad-to-pad contact

- 90-degree finger flexion



- Tweezer-like interaction

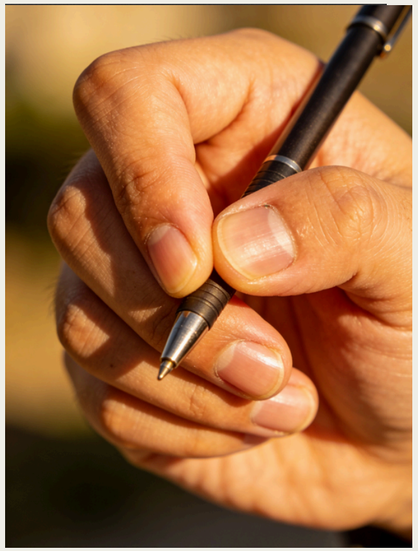
- Fingertip pressure

HUMAN INTERACTION (THE GRIP ARCHITECTURE)

The Tripod Grip (The "Writing/Stylus" Grip)

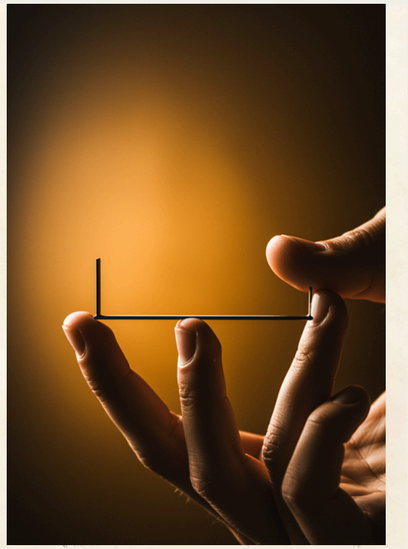
Best for: Pens, surgical tools, cosmetic brushes, or styluses.

The Physics: The thumb, index, and middle finger form a triangular support system.



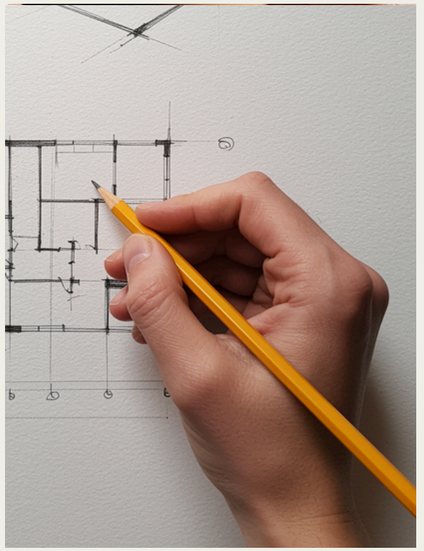
- Dynamic tripod grip

- Three-point stabilization



- Middle finger as a fulcrum

- Angular finger tension



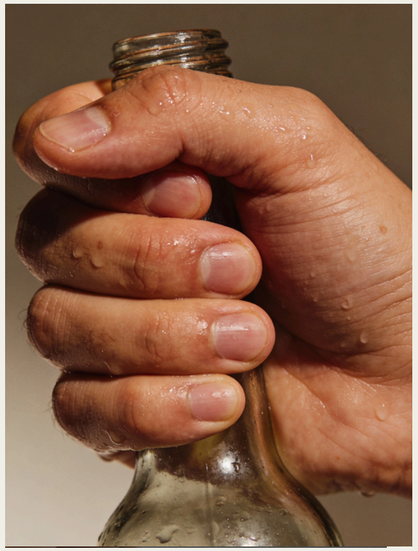
- Pencil-hold architecture

HUMAN INTERACTION (THE GRIP ARCHITECTURE)

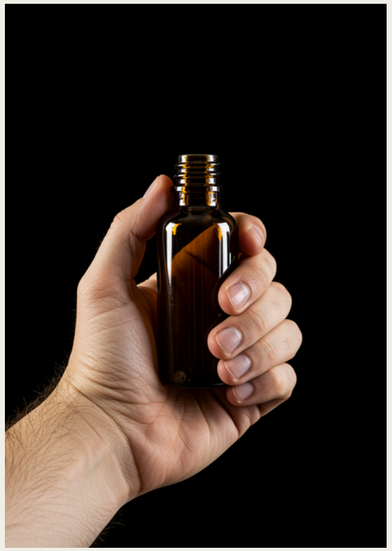
The Power Grip / Cylindrical Wrap (The "Beverage/Tool" Grip)

Best for: Soda cans, heavy power tools, flashlights, or fitness equipment.

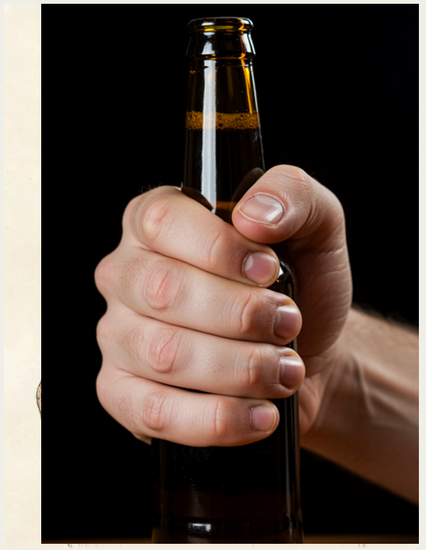
The Physics: The palm makes full contact with the object, and the fingers wrap around to meet the thumb.



- Full palmar wrap

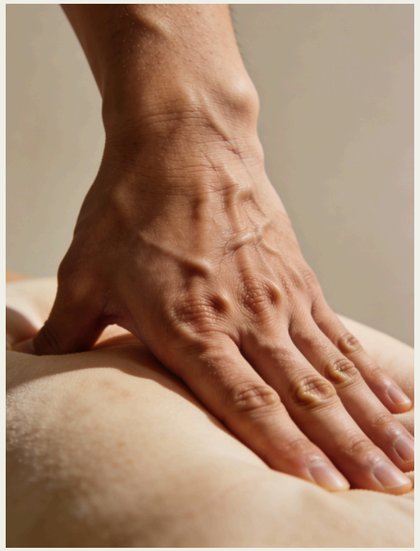


- Cylindrical grip



- Thumb-over-index lock

- Closed-fist interaction
-



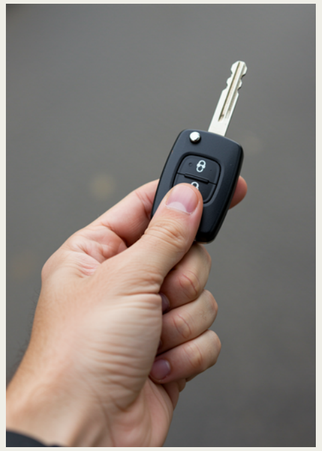
- Pencil-hold architecture

HUMAN INTERACTION (THE GRIP ARCHITECTURE)

The Lateral Pinch / Key Grip (The "Thin Object" Grip)

Best for: Car keys, credit cards, slim remote controls, or luxury slim watches.

The Physics: The thumb presses an object against the side of the index finger's second knuckle.

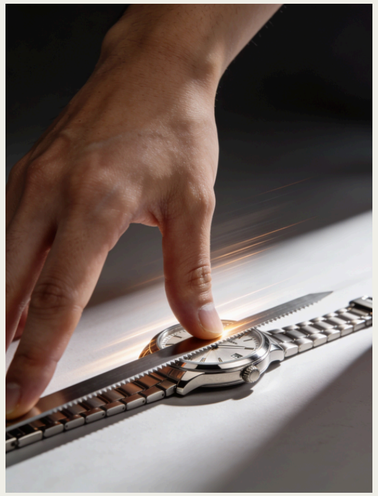


- Lateral pinch

- Key-turn grip

- Side-knuckle compression

- Thumb-pad to radial-side-of-index



- Shear-force interaction

HUMAN INTERACTION (THE GRIP ARCHITECTURE)

The Support / Palmar Rest (The "Electronics" Grip)

Best for: Tablets, books, trays, or smartphones (lifestyle shots)

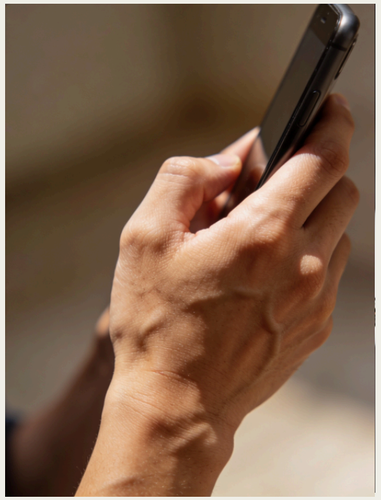
The Physics:The product rests on the open palm or flattened fingers, using gravity more than squeeze-force.

- Open palmar support
-

- Weight-bearing rest
-

- Finger splay (natural extension)

- Thumb-pad to radial-side-of-index



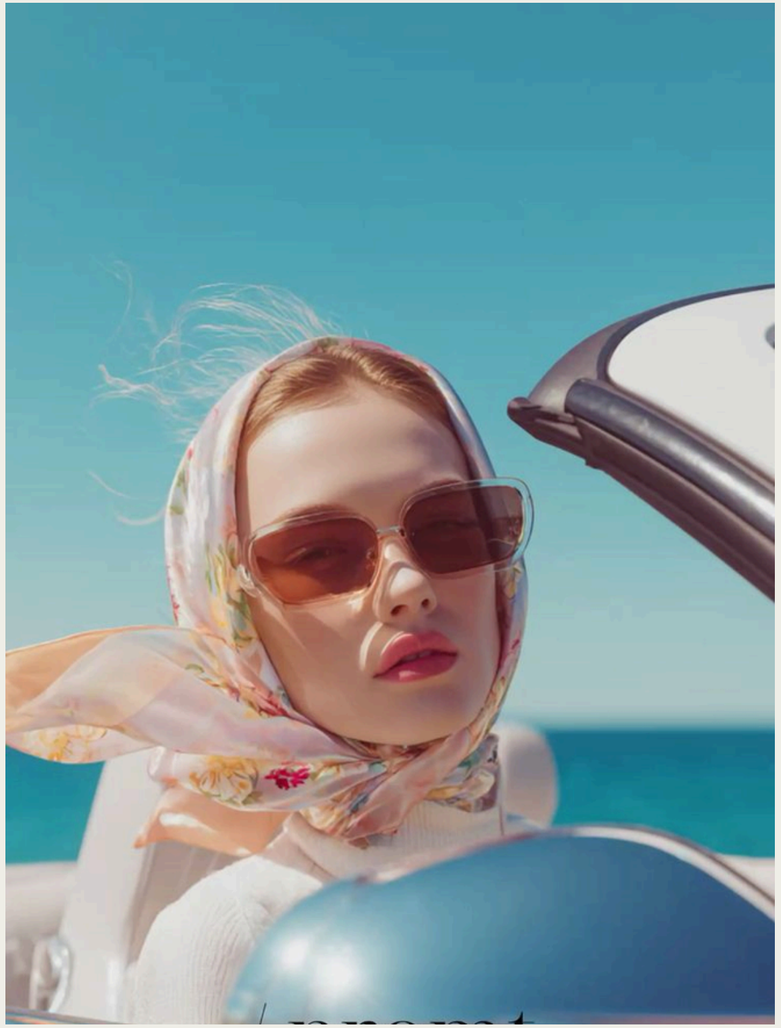
- Passive grip architecture

LIGHTING LOGIC (THE VIRTUAL GAFFER)

LIGHTING IS THE #1 CONTROL LEVER

THE 3-POINT RULE:

- **Key Light:** Defines the shape (e.g., "45-degree angle, 5600K").
- **Rim Light:** Defines the silhouette (e.g., "Sharp 170-degree back-light").
- **Fill Light:** Controls the shadows (e.g., "20% intensity white bounce").



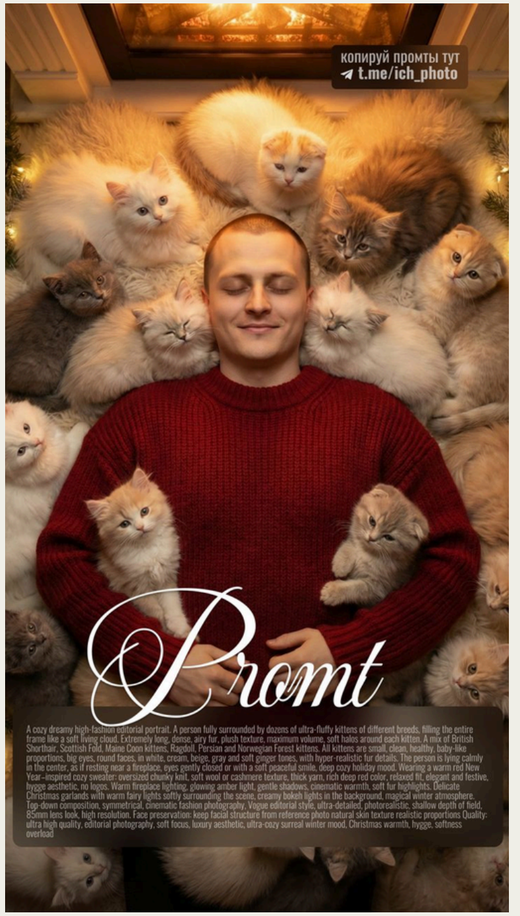
CONSTRAINTS

BLOCKING THE "AI LOOK"

Why Constraints?
Modern models aggressively stylize. You must pull them back toward reality.

Essential Negatives:

- No plastic/waxy skin.
- No CGI/Video Game gloss.
- No warped text or impossible physics.
- No lens distortion on product edges.



SURGICAL ITERATION STRATEGY

BLOCKING THE "AI LOOK"

Don't Rewrite:

If the image is 80% there, only change one variable.

The Workflow:

- Lock Subject & Composition.
- Adjust Lighting only.
- Adjust Materials only.

THE MASTER FORMULAT

[SUBJECT + ACTION] + [MATERIAL PHYSICS] + [CAMERA LENS/ANGLE] + [LIGHTING SETUP] + [ATMOSPHERE] + [MOOD] + [CONSTRAINTS].

THE MASTER FORMULAT

According to your structure, here is a detailed AI image prompt based on the provided image:

Subject + Action: A high-resolution, photorealistic hero shot of a dark metallic sapphire blue BMW M5Competition (current generation) positioned centrally on a concrete waterfront promenade at bumper level, presenting its front three-quarter view with authoritative presence.

Material Physics: High-gloss metallic blue paint finish with intricate reflections. Detailed black multi-spoke lightweight alloy wheels with large brake assemblies. Precision-carved carbon fiber splitter and diffuser.Clear LED headlight elements with an internal glow. A curved, modern architectural facade made of clean concrete and reflective glass. Serene, still lake water. Imperfect concrete pavement. Rugged, distant mountain peaks with a texture of stone and snow.

Camera Lens/Angle: Shot on a wide-angle, low-angle hero lens (approx. 24mm), making the car dominate the frame and the background vista look vast. The camera perspective is slightly below the car's grille,emphasizing power.

Lighting Setup: Golden hour (sunrise or sunset). A low sun on the far left creates a massive, strong, warm lens flare and an overall warm, atmospheric haze across the lake. The sky is a gradient from deep orange-gold near the horizon to deep cerulean blue above, with soft, diffused clouds.

Atmosphere: Tranquil, pristine, and clean. A serene lake, distant, rugged, snow-dusted mountains, and a clear, golden-hued sky with gentle, hazy light. The architecture is sleek and modern.

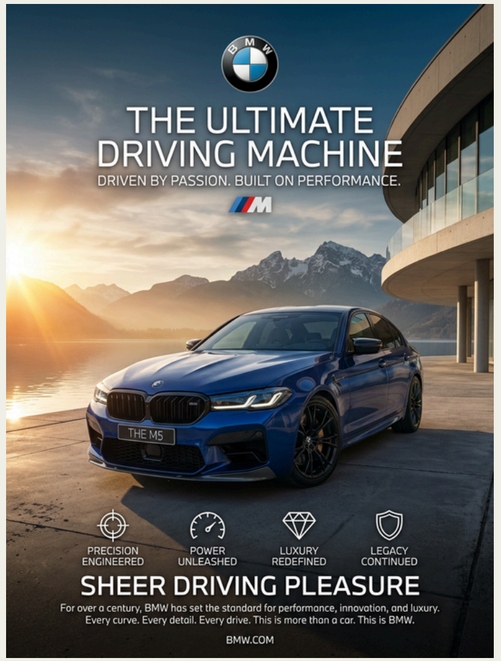
Mood: Empowering, luxurious, precisely engineered, authoritative, and sophisticated. A palpable sense of high performance and driving legacy.

Constraints (All Text and Logos must be present and perfectly legible in white):

- **Top Center:** Large metallic BMW roundel logo, followed below by large text: "THE ULTIMATE DRIVING MACHINE". Below that, in smaller text: "DRIVEN BY PASSION. BUILT ON PERFORMANCE."
- **Below Header:** A small tri-color M logo slash.
- **Front License Plate:** "THE M5".
- **Bottom of Frame (Row of four white outline icons):**
  - (Icon: Crosshair) "PRECISION ENGINEERED"
  - (Icon: Gauge) "POWER UNLEASHED"
  - (Icon: Diamond) "LUXURY REDEFINED"
  - (Icon: Shield) "LEGACY CONTINUED"
- Under Icons (Large, all caps): "SHEER DRIVING PLEASURE"
- Below Icons (Paragraph): "For over a century, BMW has set the standard for performance,innovation, and luxury. Every curve. Every detail. Every drive. This is more than a car. This is BMW."
- Very Bottom Center: "BMW.COM"

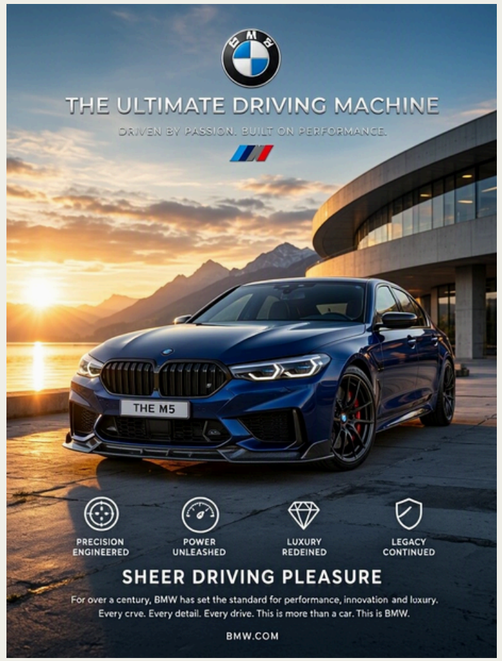
COMPARISON

GPT



NANO BANANA

SEEDREAM



MAI

Create the following items using AI

1. Create a imaginary brand logo with ai
2. A mission and vision using ai
3. Create 2 posters for your imaginary brand

Thank you!